**PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS**
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# STAFF REPORT

**Date:** October 23, 2025

**To:** Board of Education

**From:** Kristen Weiler, Risk Management

**CC:** Liz Large, Contracted Senior Legal Advisor

**Subject**: Field Trip Policy

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**Policy Summary**

The Policy Committee has moved the attached proposed amended Field Trip Policy for consideration by the full Board. Here is a summary of the substantive issues addressed in the policy, which, other than Board approval, are substantially similar to the current policy:

- Centralized field trip approval will be managed by the Senior Director of Schools and Risk Management.
- Trip leaders will foster welcoming and inclusive experiences for all students who would like to participate.
- Clear safety and behavioral expectations of adults and students.
- If a trip is not sponsored by PPS, sponsors, including staff, cannot use PPS funds, resources, or their roles as employees to support or promote the trip.
- Travel study programs are not sponsored or endorsed by PPS. These external trips must include a disclaimer, cannot use PPS names or resources, and must follow specific guidelines for sharing information and hosting meetings.

The attached chart compares the current policy to the current revision.

Significant updates include:

- Removal of Board approval on out-of-state field trips that are more than 150 miles from the Prophet Center and international trips (Risk Management's review and vetting of those and other field trips is still required).
- Reiterating an expectation of a substance-free environment on trips, noting particularly for adults which is not contained in other PPS policies.
- Updated structure and language to make it more streamlined and easier to read.

## ANALYSIS OF SITUATION

Before coming to the Board, extensive review and approval of overnight policies by the Senior Director of Schools and Risk Management must be completed.[1] The additional layer of approval for Board review, adds time pressure on schools, especially for field trips that need to be planned months in advance (*e.g.*, international trips) or those that require quick approval (*e.g.*, out of town playoff games). Some trips have needed special, single-purpose Board meetings for approval to meet the deadline of booking affordable airline tickets or meeting other time constraints.

Board approval does not add a substantive layer of risk mitigation. It does provide visibility to what trips are being taken, the cost of trips, and whether trips are being taken equitably across the District. Staff has offered to develop other means of providing that visibility.

In 2024, the Board considered additional amendments to the Policy, which were never adopted. See attached August 6, 2024, First Reading packet.

### Fiscal Impact

In some circumstances, plane fares and other prepaid expenses may vary depending on timing of final approval.

### Staff Recommendation

Staff recommends adoption of the proposed amended policy.

[1] Senior Director of Schools has to approve the field trip proposals prior to planning the trip, including reviewing plans for equity, inclusion, and financial expectations.